

year on make-up. I had no idea until I received a notification that I was entitled to their swishest sample box for being a top-tier customer. Forget buying blusher – that was a smack to make me red in the face. In Step 2, I outline some of my beauty tips and my own cheapo beauty buys, for men and women.

If you have medicines you need, don't forget to count them when figuring out how much you need a week to fill a script.

### ***Petrol (about \$25 a week)***

When the pocket money arrives, the first thing I do is fill up my car, so I am never caught without transport. Sacrificing takeaway coffee might fill you with dread, but having your car chug to a halt on the freeway, with the needle on empty, is a true nightmare. I did it twice.

### ***Public transport and/or parking meter fees (about \$20 a week)***

I am able to walk to the office some days, which saves me a decent pile of coins every week. But note that in some capital cities, or in other places where you may face a tyranny of distance to get to work, public transport or parking costs will easily be more than \$20 a week.

### ***Entertainment (about \$50 a week)***

Enough for dinner and a glass of wine on the weekend, basically. If I've been disciplined and spent less on coffee, groceries, petrol and parking meters, I have more to play with in this category. That is motivation enough to penny-pinch as much as possible during the week.

## **Part 4: Know your worth**

The period in which you receive pocket money may last months or years. Only you know when you will be ready to take back control and start independently budgeting. Removing temptations, as part of the Pocket Money Savings Plan, will help you understand what has motivated your splurges and move to this state of independence.

By limiting access to my money, I was able to pause and consider why I was overspending, and work on diluting that poison. The root of the